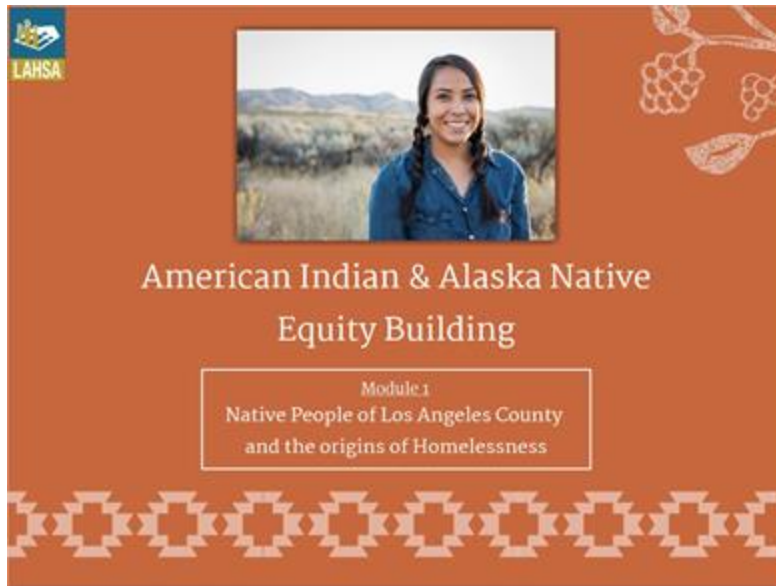


American Indian & Alaska Native Equity Building E-Learning Course

Module 1 Script and Storyboard

Slide 1.1 – Welcome

Welcome to LAHSA's American Indian & Alaska Native Equity Building E-Learning Course. As a trusted homeless service provider, your work is essential for fostering a more culturally responsive continuum of care. Together, we serve more Indigenous people than any other county in the United States. This course aims to enhance care for our Native neighbors.



Source: [Snapshot Infographic](#);

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 1.2 – Course Navigation

Before we get started, let's look at some course navigation basics. This course requires listening, so please make sure your audio is on. Closed captions can be accessed by clicking this icon. A table of contents is available on the left side of the screen. This will allow you to navigate to slides you've already completed. A resources button is at the top right of the course player. Here, you'll be able to download materials referenced throughout the module. Move forward in the course by clicking the right arrow. It will appear after you've completed the necessary material on each slide. Move to previous slides using the left arrow. Click the right arrow to begin.



Slide 1.3 – Creators

This training has been modeled from curriculum created and facilitated by the professionals on the screen. Hovering over their names will reveal more about their backgrounds.

Modeled from curriculum created and facilitated by

Pamela Villaseñor

*Fernandeño Tataviam
Executive Director,
Pukúu Cultural Community Services*

Andrea Garcia

*Mandan, Hidatsa, Arikara
Physician Specialist,
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Lauren van Schilfgaarde

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San Manuel Band of Mission Indians
Director,
Tribal Legal Development Clinic, UCLA School of Law*

Danielle Tobey

*Mashpee Wampanoag, Cape Verdean
Torres Martinez Tribal TANF
Family & Children's Services Coordinator*

(hovering over a name/picture reveals additional text)

Sources: Slide 1 of [Original Curriculum](#);

Photo Sources: [Pukuu Website](#); [LA County Website](#); [UCLA Law website](#); [Social Justice Partners LA](#)

Slide 1.4 - Course Structure

The purpose of this course is to foster cultural humility in Los Angeles County's homeless care delivery system. It contains three modules, the first of which you are experiencing now. Here are the titles of all three modules.

1 – Native People of Los Angeles County and Origins of Homelessness

2 – Identity, Terminology, and Symptoms of Structural Racism

3 – Special Considerations and Practices for Working Native People Experiencing Homelessness

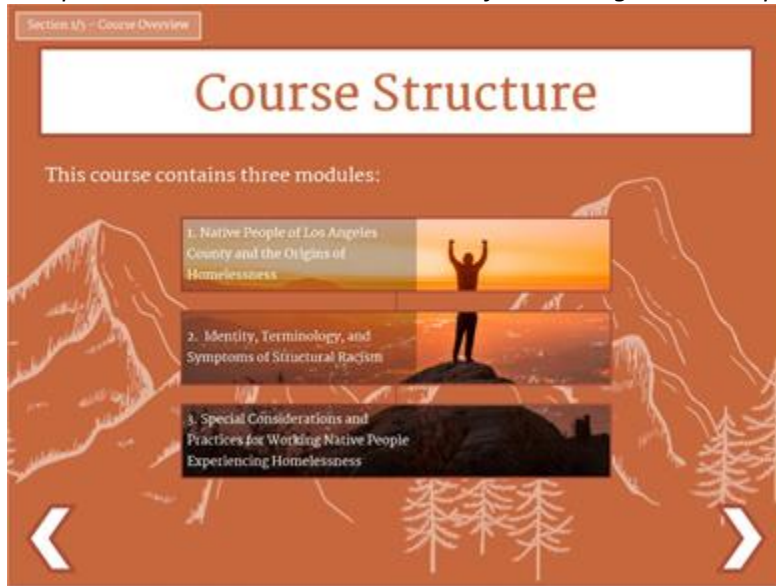


Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 1.5 - Module Structure

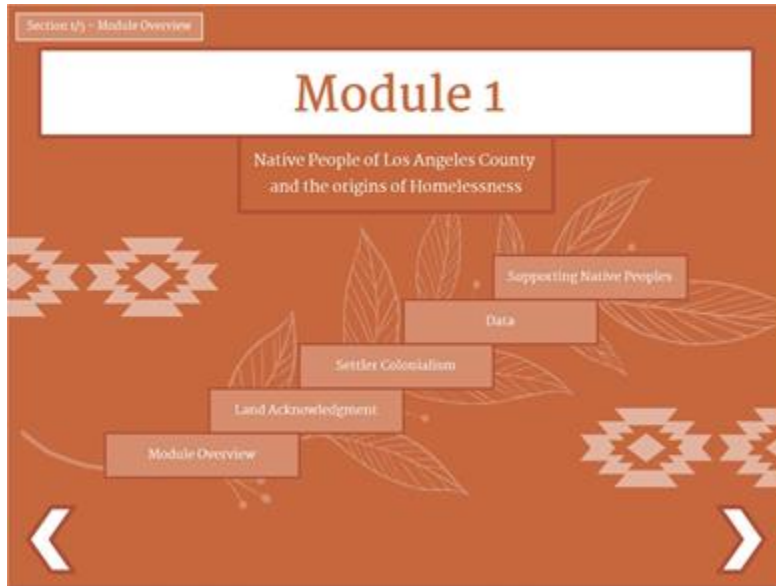
Module one focuses on Native people of Los Angeles County and the origins of homelessness in their population.

This module will address the historical and present **displacement** of Native peoples. Displacement is a term used to describe the intentional removal and marginalization of a culture or people. Consider, do you know the history of your area? Who were the earliest inhabitants and what stories do you know of them? Displacement is the removal of Native people and their history from these lands, which we'll address in this module.

This module has 5 sections

1. Module Overview
2. Land Acknowledgment
3. Settler Colonialism
4. Data
5. Supporting Native Peoples

The rectangle at the top left of the screen will always show you what section you're in.



Slide 1.6 – Objectives

This module has three objectives.

By the end of this module, you will

1. Acknowledge the Indigenous nations of Los Angeles County
2. Recall the history of settler colonialism and its effect on Native people
3. Explore resources to further engage with the Native American community

Meeting these objectives will lay the groundwork for building a more culturally responsive homeless care delivery system.



Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 1.7 - Land Acknowledgement Transition

"What is done to the land is done to the people." -Kimberly Morales-Johnson; Gabrieleno/Tongva San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians



Source: [LA County We are still here report](#)

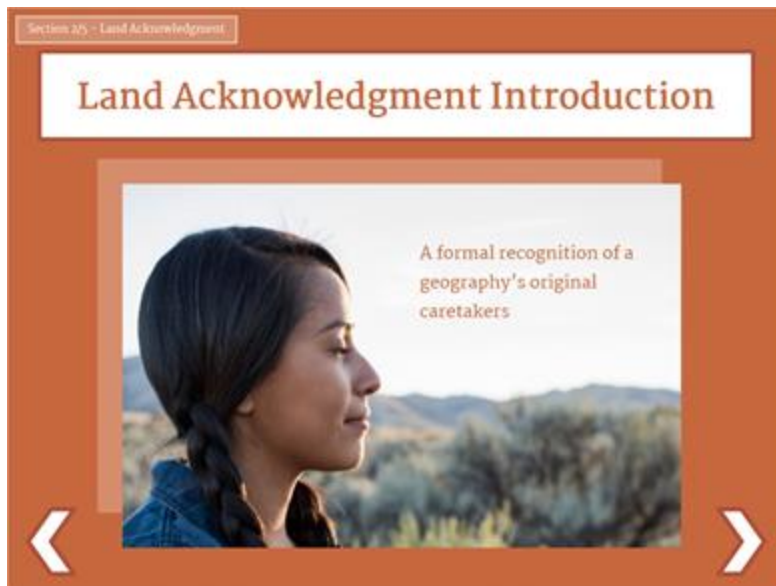
Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 2.1 - Land Acknowledgment Intro

Let's begin with a Land Acknowledgment. Why? Because these lands are the connecting thread of Native history.

Native people have suffered a long history of inequity and discriminatory treatment. Across their homelands, they have faced the relentless forces of systematic genocide and cultural erasure. Colonial structures, both physical and ideological, have forcibly displaced Native communities. These colonial forces have stripped away their homes and association to the land, as if their history and presence didn't exist.

A land acknowledgement is a formal recognition of a geography's original caretakers. It is an opportunity to showcase Indigenous resilience and a primary step towards more equitable relationships. Land acknowledgements should happen at the beginning of any event. This includes conferences, celebrations, presentations, and meetings. You will hear a land acknowledgement on the next slide. Listen to how it honors Native experiences and celebrates Indigenous strength.



Source: [ChatGPT](#) (for language support)

Photo Sources: [Canva](#);

Slide 2.2 – Course Land Acknowledgment

The County of Los Angeles recognizes that we occupy land originally and still inhabited and cared for by the Tongva, Tataviam, Serrano, Kizh, and Chumash Peoples. We honor and pay respect to their elders and descendants — past, present, and emerging — as they continue their stewardship of these lands and waters. We acknowledge that settler colonization resulted in land seizure, disease, subjugation, slavery, relocation, broken promises, genocide, and multigenerational trauma. This acknowledgment demonstrates our responsibility and commitment to truth, healing, and reconciliation and to elevating the stories, culture, and community of the original inhabitants of Los Angeles County. We are grateful to have the opportunity to live and work on these ancestral lands. We are dedicated to growing and sustaining relationships with Native peoples and local tribal governments, including (in no particular order) the

[Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians](#)

[Gabrielino Tongva Indians of California Tribal Council](#)

[Gabrielino/Tongva San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians](#)

[Gabrieleño Band of Mission Indians – Kizh Nation](#)

[San Manuel Band of Mission Indians](#)

[San Fernando Band of Mission Indians](#)

Hover over each nation to see their pronunciation. Click on them to visit their websites.

The land acknowledgment spoken on this slide is the official land acknowledgment of Los Angeles County.



(hovering over a nation reveals its pronunciation)



Sources: tribal nation websites (linked above); [LA County Website](#); [VIMEO](#);

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 2.3 – Land Acknowledgment Importance

A land acknowledgment pays tribute to the Indigenous nations who inhabited the land in the past and present. It does not right the wrongs of history, but is a primary step towards more ethical partnerships. Land acknowledgments set a framework to redress the marginalization of Native communities.

By acknowledging the original overseers of the land we occupy, we seek to understand and appreciate Indigenous populations' histories, presence, and outlooks. Click on the video to hear the perspective of a Native person after witnessing a land acknowledgement.

[Video](#) (0:58 – 1:49)



Source: [US Department of Arts and Culture Video](#)

Slide 2.4 – Land Acknowledgment Best Practices

We want you to have the tools to support and deliver land acknowledgments with confidence. LA County has an official land acknowledgement we encourage you to use for all events in LA County. It was thoughtfully developed over several months with local nations. Download it in the Resources section of the course player. Click on the questions below to explore land acknowledgement best practices.

Who should deliver the land acknowledgment? - A staff member of your organization, preferably someone in a leadership position. It is not appropriate to ask a representative of a local Native nation that is not an employee of your organization.

When should the acknowledgement happen? – As close to the beginning of an event as possible

How should the acknowledgement happen? – In a non-prerecorded format whenever possible

Want to learn more? Explore Los Angeles County's Land Acknowledgement and Land Acknowledgment toolkit [here](#).

Land Acknowledgment Best Practices

Who should deliver the land acknowledgment?

When should the acknowledgment happen?

How should the land acknowledgment happen?



Want to learn more? Explore Los Angeles County's Land Acknowledgement and Land Acknowledgment toolkit [here](#).



(clicking a question makes additional text/imagery appear)

Land Acknowledgment Best Practices

Who should deliver the land acknowledgment?

When should the acknowledgment happen?

How should the land acknowledgment happen?

A staff member of your organization, preferably someone in a leadership position. It is not appropriate to ask a representative of a local Native nation that is not an employee of your organization.



Want to learn more? Explore Los Angeles County's Land Acknowledgement and Land Acknowledgment toolkit [here](#).



Land Acknowledgment Best Practices

Who should deliver the land acknowledgment?

When should the acknowledgment happen?

How should the land acknowledgment happen?

As close to the beginning of an event as possible



Want to learn more? Explore Los Angeles County's Land Acknowledgement and Land Acknowledgment toolkit [here](#).



Land Acknowledgment Best Practices

Who should deliver the land acknowledgment?

When should the acknowledgment happen?

How should the land acknowledgment happen?

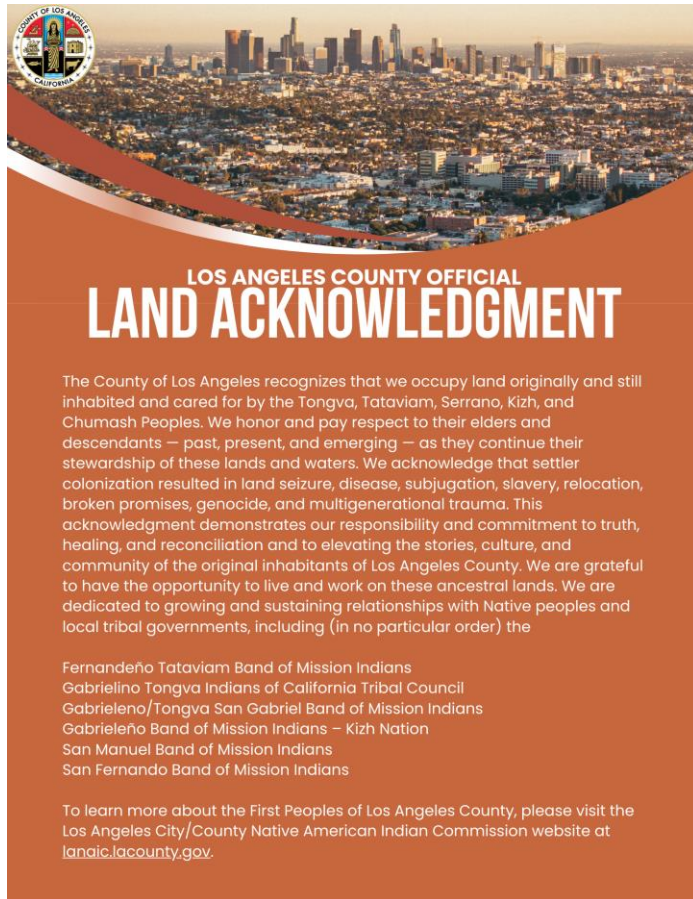
In a non-prerecorded format whenever possible



Want to learn more? Explore Los Angeles County's Land Acknowledgement and Land Acknowledgment toolkit [here](#).



Below is the document learners will be able to download from the resources section:



Source: [LA County Website](#); SME meeting; [Fernandeno Tataviam Website](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 2.5 Land Acknowledgment Scenario

You've been asked to organize an event to celebrate a milestone at your organization. Your colleague, Kayla, asks you if you plan on incorporating a land acknowledgment. Explore all responses to see their consequences. The "next" button will appear after you've clicked on all options (not just the best option).

Kayla: Will there be a land acknowledgment at our celebration?

Option 1:

I appreciate you considering that. Unfortunately, we have a tight schedule, and I don't think we have time for it. It might also distract from the purpose of the event. Maybe next time.

Consequences: Kayla thanks you for your explanation, and respectfully expresses disappointment. She says she hopes to see it in future events. At the event, you notice another coworker, Brian, who seems less celebratory than the rest of your colleagues. You approach him privately to see if you can support him. Brian expresses that he has Native origins and was really hoping to see a land acknowledgement incorporated. He shares that it would have helped him feel recognized and part of the team he recently joined.

Option 2:

Yes, I'm going to see if Dalia wants to do it. I think her dad is Native? She'll definitely do a better job pronouncing the tribe than any of us.

Consequences: Kayla says ok, but you sense some trepidation. You approach Dalia that afternoon, and ask her if she could handle the land acknowledgment. Dalia expresses that she doesn't think acknowledging her own people should be her responsibility, and it would make more sense to come from a non-Native person in a leadership role. You thank Dalia for her perspective, but end up prioritizing other aspects of the event over the land acknowledgment. Ultimately, the land acknowledgment never takes place. Dalia leaves the organization two months later and cites equity concerns in her exit interview.

Option 3:

Yes, I've obtained LA County's land acknowledgment, and am in the process of practicing pronouncing the nations correctly. It is the first agenda item on our celebration.

Consequences: The land acknowledgment takes place at the beginning of the event. Many colleagues convey that it was the first time they witnessed one. Some express interest in learning more about their local Native communities. Two colleagues approach you privately that day, and share that they have Native origins. They both share that the land acknowledgment was very appreciated. One gives some respectful feedback for how it can be even better next time.

Option 4:

Hopefully! I just want to make sure the group energy feels right. I'm planning on having it in the middle of the presentation.

Consequences: Kayla shares that she believes the acknowledgement should go at the beginning of the event, and you thank her for the feedback. At the event, one of the presenters facilitates a team-building game that results in an abundance of laughter. The place you had planned on putting the land acknowledgment was right after the game. It now feels like such an awkward tonal shift that you decide to not do it at all. Kayla is more distant in the future and doesn't express her ideas to you directly.

End feedback (after all options have been clicked) - Option 3 is the most respectful and effective plan of action. It shows the level of care and attention required for a well delivered land acknowledgment. Native employees feel appreciated, and other employees are inspired to learn more.



(after clicking each option, imagery would appear to align with narration)

Slide 2.6 - Settler Colonialism Transition

"Like white fragility, settler fragility is the inability to talk about unearned privilege – in this case, the privilege of living on lands that were taken in the name of democracy through profound violence and injustice." - Dina Gilio-Whitaker; Colville Confederated Tribes



Source: [LA County We are Still Here Report](#); [Beaconbroadside.com](#); [authorsbound.com](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 3.1 – Settler Colonialism Introduction

The displacement of Indigenous communities is rooted in the historical legacy of settler colonialism. It is the perpetuating source of Native homelessness. [Oxford Languages Dictionary](#) defines settler colonialism as “a type of colonialism in which the Indigenous peoples of a colonized region are displaced

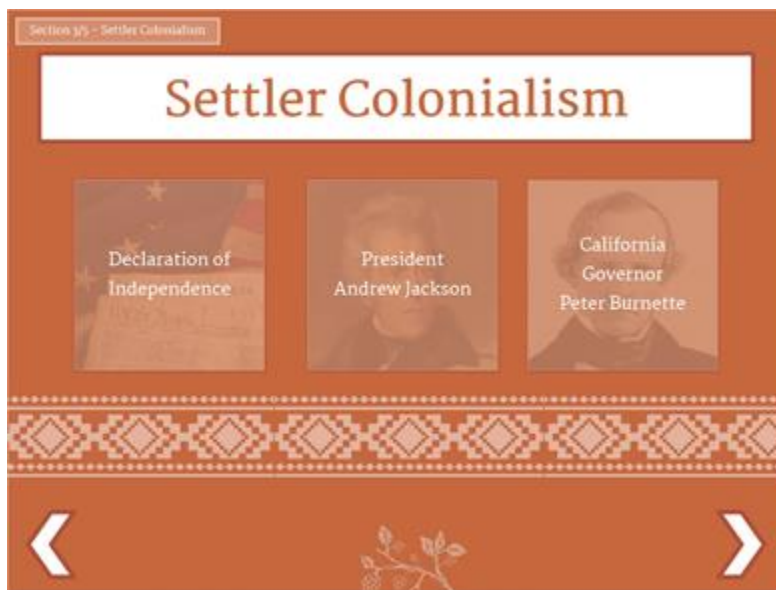
by settlers who permanently form a society there.” This permanence makes settler colonialism persistent and difficult to recognize. It works as a mechanism to erase Native presence, ownership, and contribution. These attributes are then replaced with colonial perspectives that give no credit to Native Americans.

The goal of settler colonialism is acquiring land as an asset. The first settlers saw Native bodies as a barrier to that goal, and the settler response was genocide and erasure. Click on the images below to see how settler colonialism has been present the United States.

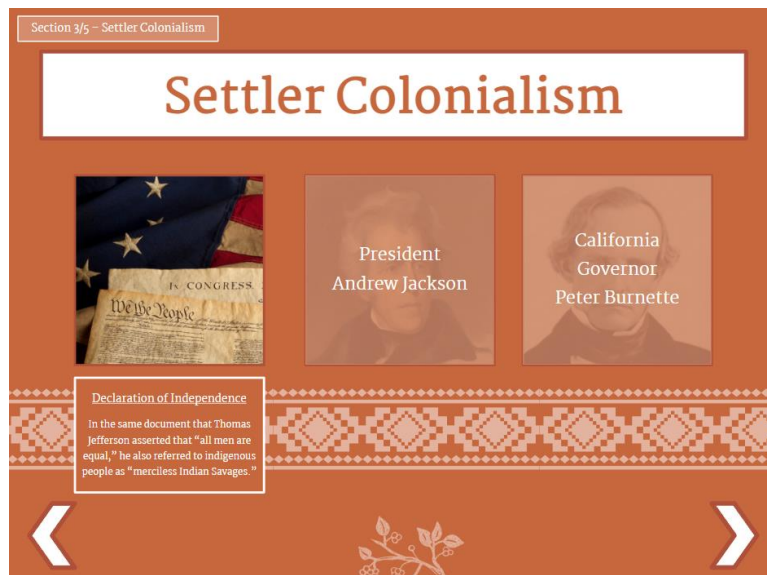
Declaration of Independence – In the same document that Thomas Jefferson asserted that “all men are equal,” he also referred to indigenous people as “merciless Indian Savages.”

President Andrew Jackson – In his speech regarding the Indian Removal Act of 1830, Andrew Jackson suggested that the removal of Native people from their homelands could “cast off their savage habits” to “become an interesting, civilized, and Christian community.”

California Governor Peter Burnette – In California Governor Peter Burnette’s 1852 state of the state address, he said the following - “...a war of extermination will continue to be waged between the races until the Indian race becomes extinct...”



(clicking an option makes additional text appear)



Sources: [Oxford Language Dictionary](#); [Governors library](#); [Transcription of On Indian Removal](#); [National Archives](#); [SME meeting](#); end homelessness [video](#); [chatgpt](#)
Photo Sources: [Canva](#); [Wikipedia](#)

Slide 3.2 – Settler Colonialism Continues

Land theft and genocide are the origins of Native homelessness. The concept of homelessness did not exist before settlers made contact with Indigenous populations. Through settler colonialism, Native social life and customs were significantly disrupted.

But settler colonialism is not a single event – it is a structured process that continues today. Every non-Native person who occupies the homeland of a tribal community is a settler. White supremacist systems continue to corroborate inequity by privileging a narrow scope of history that ignores the generational impacts on Native communities.

Click on the video to hear more from Naoko Shibusawa of Brown University.

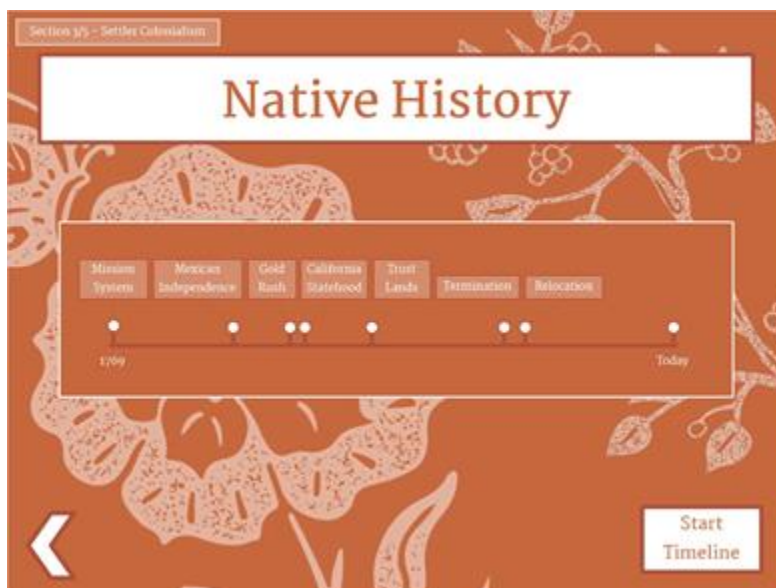
[Video](#) (0:39 – 1:14)



Sources: [SME meeting](#); end homelessness [video](#)

Slide 3.3 – History Introduction

Native people across many continents have suffered intergenerational trauma through settler colonialism. By learning this history, we begin to address the displacement of Native people from our history, understanding how and why it happened. The following slides give a concise history of 7 events showcasing Native resilience in LA County, the region where we provide services. Click “Start Timeline” to begin.



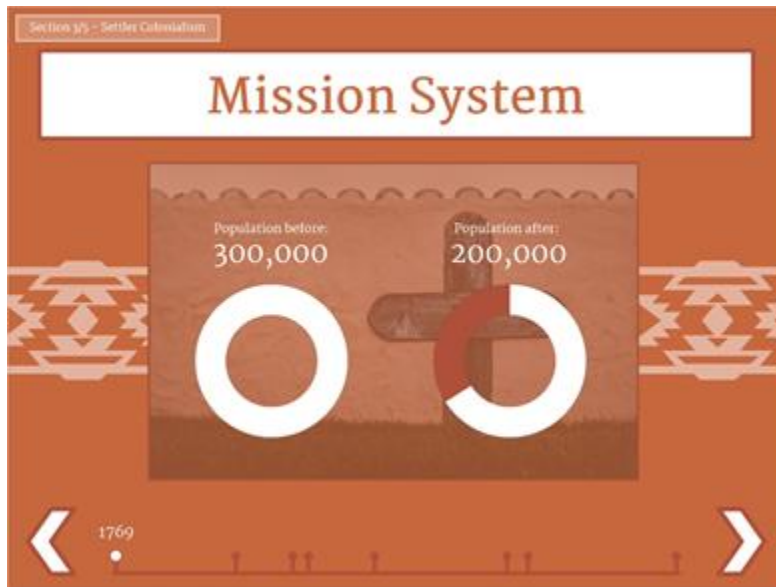
Slide 3.4 – History - Mission System (1769)

Spanish settlers enslaved Native people in the California Mission System. Indigenous populations were forced into labor to establish Spain’s presence to both Native and European nations. The mission system attempted to convert Native people to Christianity through a means of physical violence and cultural

suppression. This forced assimilation was paired with the theft of natural resources. Missions were geographically positioned to exploit this. Due to proximity to the settlers, Native people were susceptible to diseases they had no immunity for. One third of Indigenous Californians died, but survivors fought for the preservation of their cultural values.

Population before: 300,000

Population after: 200,000



Source: [ca.gov](https://www.ca.gov/); [Daily Meditations website](https://www.dailymeditations.com/); [brainly.com](https://www.brainly.com/)

Image Source: Articulate

Slide 3.5 – History – Mexican Independence (1821)

The Mexican War of Independence granted Mexico liberation from Spain. The Mexican ranchos system granted land rights to private individuals, almost none of which were Native American. Original Native ownership of the land was displaced with settler ownership. This system continued to disperse Native communities and disrupt land use patterns. The new government abolished slavery, but the practice persisted with minimal effort to stop it.

Mexican Independence



Continued to

- disperse Native communities
- disrupt land use patterns

1821

Sources: [Washington post](#); [Secularization and the Rancho Era](#)

Image Source: [nohat.cc](#); [Santa Barbara Mission Archive Library](#) (picture downloaded from [National Park Service](#))

Slide 3.6 – History - Gold Rush (1848)

Further invasion ensued when gold was found in California. A new wave of settlers brought forth one of Native communities' darkest periods. In the relentless pursuit of gold, colonizers murdered Native Americans and displaced them of their land, creating settlements and forcibly moving Native people by means of violence. The federal government endorsed these practices by reimbursing paramilitary troops who existed to kill Native people. Without respect for the surrounding resources, settlers engaged in mining practices that exploited the environment and devastated its original overseers. Within a couple years, the Native population was cut in half.

Population before: 200,000

Population after: 100,000

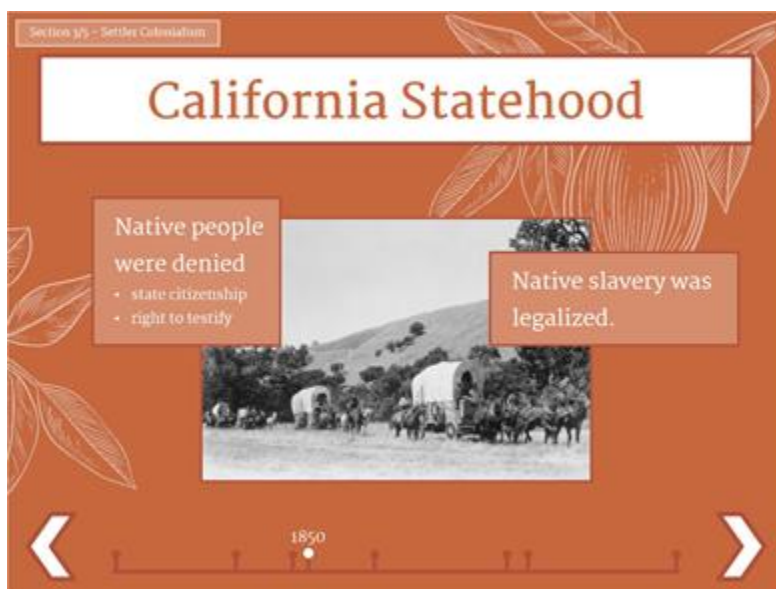


Source: [PBS](#); [Legislative Analyst's Office](#); [nahc.ca.gov](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 3.7 – History – California Statehood (1850)

California's booming population made statehood a priority that was granted in 1850. Cultural erasure continued as Native people were denied state citizenship and the right to testify in court. This precedent set the framework for even worse legislation when Native slavery was legalized. Native slavery was permitted as long as enslaved men were younger than 30 and enslaved women were younger than 25. To exploit this practice, settlers killed Native parents to indenture their children. Native slavery persisted until President Lincoln's 1863 emancipation proclamation.



Source: [PBS](#); [Legislative Analyst's Office](#); [nahc.ca.gov](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 3.8 – History – Trust Lands (mid 19th century)

Reservations and rancherias were created by the United States government to concentrate Native people on undesirable land. Because Native people did not have settler-defined ownership of the land, they were put in a position to accept these conditions over possessing no land at all. Even then, land rights were granted inequitably, with the Native inhabitants of many southern California counties ignored. Native populations fostered community bonds and continued to advocate for their rights.



Source: [ca.gov](https://www.ca.gov)

Photo Source: [Canva](https://www.canva.com)

Slide 3.9 – History – Termination (1950s-1960s)

Federal recognition allows Native nations access to resources to manage their affairs. Federal recognition and support of tribal nations were rescinded through Termination policies of the 1950s and 1960s. This led to a lack of medical care, education, and employment in Native populations. Many Indigenous people had to sell their land to survive. Termination policies proved yet another layer of displacement. It set the groundwork for systemized poverty that many Native people suffer today.



Source: [ca.gov](https://www.ca.gov)

Photo Source: Articulate

Slide 3.10 – History – Relocation (1950s – 1970s)

Relocation policies were another effort aimed at forced assimilation of Native communities. The federal government sought to move Native American people to urban areas. This physically erased Native people's historical ties to their homes. By unrooting them from the land, they were deprived of their community and culture. In their new urban surroundings, Indigenous communities were not given the proper support to prosper. Many lost cultural ties and communal living conditions.



Source: [National Archives](#); [SME Video](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 3.11 – History – Today

Today, Los Angeles County is home to more Native people than any other county in the United States, with a population of more than 327,000. They represent more than 200 different Tribal Nations from across the country. How many Indigenous people are experiencing homelessness in LA County? The next section will review data trends and challenges regarding the Native homeless community.



Source: [Snapshot Infographic](#);

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 3.12 - Data Transition

"Truth is the first step to the recovery of our stolen land and broken promises." - Chairman Robert Dorame; Gabrielino Tongva Indians of California



Source: [LA County We are Still Here Report](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 4.1 – Data

The historical displacement of Native people has a lasting impact on the communities that exist today. There is an overrepresentation of homelessness in Native communities. These numbers are continuing to rise. Complicating the effort to address this fact is conflicting data across different sources.

In this section, we will:

- 1) review the research data on Native people experiencing homelessness, and
- 2) analyze the challenges related to accurately surveying these communities.

As you review the numbers on the following slides, keep in mind that each data point represents individuals. These data points are formed from different approaches to define and count people of an American Indian and Alaska Native identity, including some that include mixed identities and others that do not. It is because of the inclusivity and exclusivity (whether to include people of mixed backgrounds) that there is significant variation from one study to another.



Slide 4.2 - Data - Overrepresentation

In Los Angeles County, Native people are overrepresented in the population of people experiencing homelessness, and have many reasons for experiencing homelessness. Click on each attribute to review some of the data.



Sources: [2023 Homeless Count Slide Deck](#); [Homelessness Policy Research Institute analysis](#),
Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 4.2 – Data– Overrepresentation – Homelessness (layer 1)

The 2023 Point in Time Count demonstrates that although American Indian & Alaska Native people of non-Hispanic descent represented 0.2% of LA County’s population, they represented a magnitude of fivefold in the homeless population.

Homelessness

All - 0.2%

American Indian & Alaska Native – 1%



Source: [2023 Homeless Count Slide Deck](#)

Slide 4.2 – Data– Overrepresentation – 2019 Homelessness Policy Research Institute analysis (layer 2)

A subpopulation analysis of the 2019 Homeless Count by the Homelessness Policy Research Institute found that Native people were overrepresented in three reasons why they were experiencing homelessness – eviction or foreclosure, uninhabitable living conditions, and medical disability or illness.

Reasons for Homelessness

Eviction or Foreclosure – 25% American Indian & Alaska Native; 8% all

Uninhabitable Living Conditions – 14% American Indian & Alaska Native; 5% all

Medical Disability or Illness – 12% American Indian & Alaska Native; 8% all



Source: [Homelessness Policy Research Institute analysis,](#)

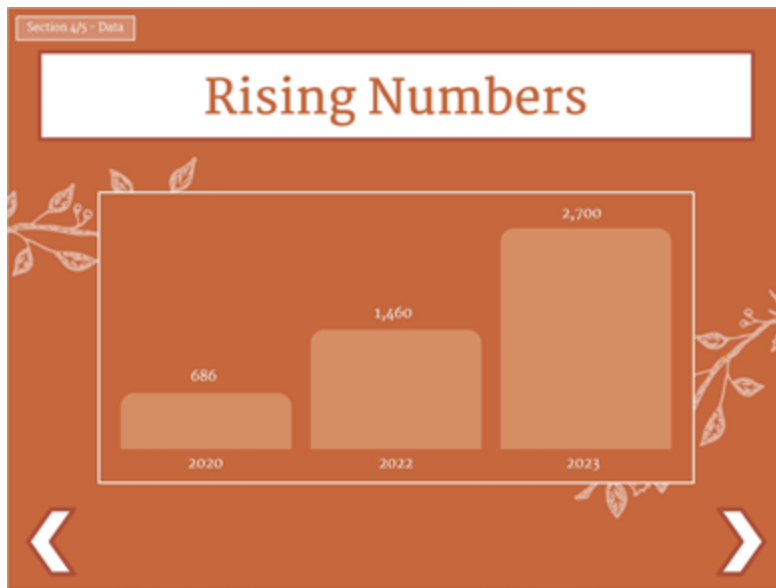
Slide 4.3 – Data– Rising Numbers

Homelessness is rising in Native communities. Between 2020 and 2022, the Los Angeles County point in time counts showed an increase of 113% of American Indian & Alaska Native people experiencing homelessness. Between 2022 and 2023, there was another increase of 85%. These are alarming numbers that demand our attention.

2020 - 686

2022 – 1,460

2023 – 2,700

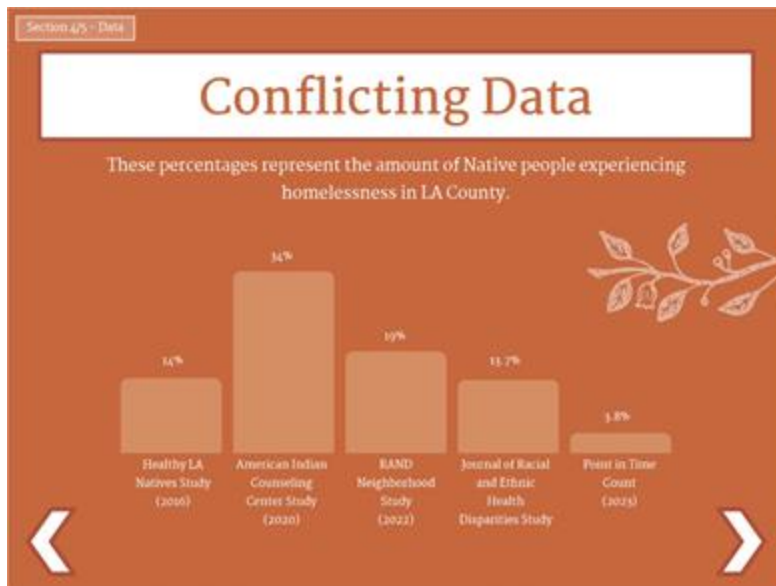


Source: 2023 [LAHSA data summary](#); 2020 [LAHSA data summary](#); 2022 [LAHSA data summary](#)

Slide 4.4 – Data– Conflicting Data

Data is the engine that drives our services. With accurate information, we can provide more effective care. There is conflicting data regarding the American Indian and Alaska Native homeless population. According to five different sources, the percentages shown represent the number of Native people experiencing homelessness in LA County. While these sources have different sample sizes and their studies were conducted at different times, their wide discrepancy warrants curiosity. Review the differing data points in the chart.

- *Healthy LA Natives Study (2016): 14%*
- *American Indian Counseling Center Study (2020): 34%*
- *RAND Neighborhood Study (2022): 19%*
- *Journal of Racial and Ethnic Health Disparities Study: 13.7%*
- *Point in Time Count (2023): 3.8%*



Source: [Snapshot Infographic](#); [healthy la natives study](#); [LA Continuum of Care Data Summary](#), slide 20 of original curriculum; [Psychiatric Diagnoses and Commercialized Tobacco Use Paper](#); [RAND Paper](#); [Society for Applied Anthropology paper](#); [Patterns of Health Care Access Paper](#)

Slide 4.5 – Data– Reason for Conflicting Data

The reason for such a wide range of conflicting data stems from the complex nature of American Indian and Alaska Native identity. There is often a failure to capture that complexity in data collection and reporting processes. Definitions of American Indian & Alaska Native are different across different sources, and most of these sources erase large swaths of the population.

Due to the history of invasion and displacement of Indigenous people, most members of the American Indian & Alaska Native population have mixed identities. Unfortunately, these identities are often lumped into “mixed race” or “other” categories without any connection to Native origins. This practice doesn’t properly honor Native backgrounds, and prevents us from optimizing our services.



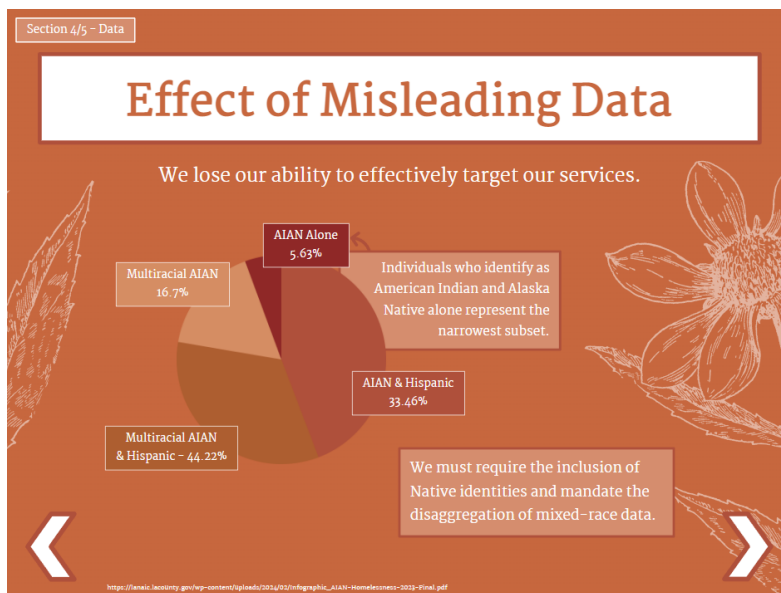
Source: [End Homelessness Video](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 4.6 – Data– Effects of Misleading Data

When we lose the ability to disaggregate mixed identities, we lose our ability to effectively target our services. Remember the data presented regarding overrepresentation in American Indian and Alaska Native people experiencing homelessness? These numbers were reflective of a non-inclusive definition. They accounted for individuals who identified as American Indian and Alaska Native alone – the narrowest subset within the broader American Indian and Alaska Native community. According to the 2020 Census, this represents only 5.6% of the AIAN population, a drastic erasure of the remaining AIAN population. We believe that the overrepresentation would be even wider if a more inclusive definition was used.

We must collect and report accurate Native data by requiring the inclusion of Native identities and mandating the disaggregation of mixed-race data. This will enhance our data which drives the services we provide.



Source: [LA County Infographic](#)

Slide 4.7 - Support Transition

"We need the county to go past being an ally and be an advocate for us." - Kimberly Morales-Johnson; Gabrieleno/Tongva San Gabriel Band of Mission Indians



Source: [LA County We are Still Here Report](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 5.1 – Support Native Peoples in Los Angeles– Intro

We can actively address the historical and present displacement of Native people in the work we do. As already discussed, land acknowledgment is a primary step towards equity for Native peoples. Our Continuum of Care seeks to go beyond acknowledgment and support Indigenous people. The following slides will cover three ways to do that. They are:

1. Understand local tribal history and status
2. Don't just acknowledge, build relationships
3. Act after acknowledgment



Source: [LAHSA CDE Presentation](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 5.2 – Support – Understand Local Tribe History and Status

Support begins with understanding. You are encouraged to research the Indigenous nations of the land and surrounding lands you occupy to understand local tribe history and status. American Indian & Alaska Native people are not just people of the past, they are people of the present and future. Take initiative to learn about their perspectives and objectives by visiting their permitted digital and physical spaces. Remain cognizant that your learning is your responsibility. The more you learn, the more you will be prepared to take action.



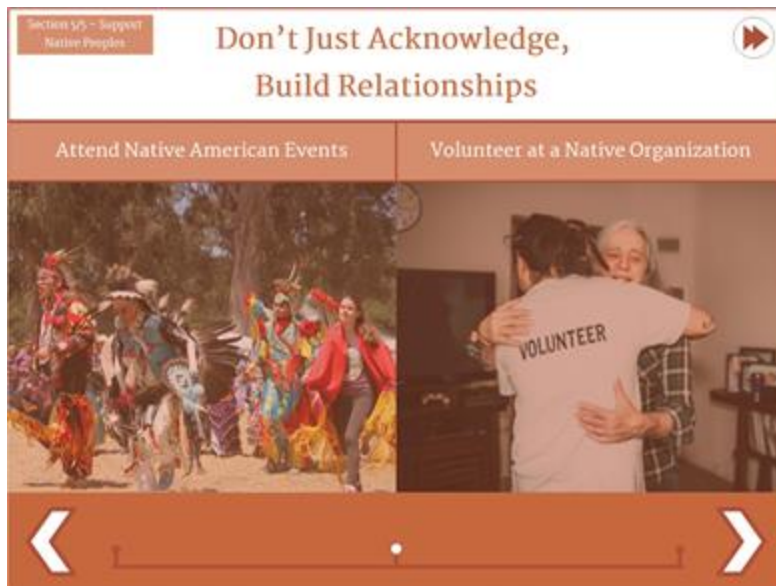
Slide 5.3 – Support – Don't Just Acknowledge, Build Relationships

Don't just acknowledge, build relationships. You can do this by:

1. Attending Native American events
2. Volunteering at a Native organization

We recognize that these actions are outside of your professional responsibilities. The remainder of this module will cover ways to further engage and support Native communities. Being an authentic ally means serving with intention, and we encourage that.

You have the option to visit the closing slide of this module by clicking this button. We encourage your commitment to learning about supporting Native communities by following the main navigation. Learn more about building relationships by clicking on each picture.



source: [native california website](#)

Photo source: [Canva](#)

Slide 5.3 – Support – Don't Just Acknowledge, Build Relationships – Attend Native Events (Layer 1)

Here are some Native events that happen in Los Angeles. Hover over each to learn more. Clicking on the name of the event will take you to its website. Download the “Native Events Handout” in the resources section of the course player.

[American Indian Arts Festival](#): The Autry Museum hosts this arts festival every June. Attendees can expect theatrical performances, live music, and dancing.

[LA Skins Fest](#): This free film festival occurs annually in November to coincide with Native American Heritage Month. It screens films exclusively by Native filmmakers.

[Native Voices Performances](#): Native Voices produces plays of all genres by Native writers. They host a variety of events including an annual playwrights retreat and annual short play festival.

[Moompetam American Indian Festival](#): Aquarium of the Pacific hosts this annual festival celebrating Indigenous cultures of Southern California. It features “traditional cultural craft demonstrations, storytelling, music, and dance.”

Indigenous Peoples’ Day: This holiday takes place the second Monday each October. There are a variety of venues that host events. As the date approaches, research to select one that involves the participation of Native people.



Below is the handout referenced in the narration:

NATIVE EVENTS

CLICK ON THE EVENTS TO VISIT THEIR WEBSITES

[American Indian Arts Festival](#)

The Autry Museum hosts this arts festival every June. Attendees can expect theatrical performances, live music, and dancing.

[LA Skins Fest](#)

This free film festival occurs annually in November to coincide with Native American Heritage Month. It screens films exclusively by Native filmmakers.

[Native Voices Performances](#)

Native Voices produces plays of all genres by Native writers. They host a variety of events including an annual playwrights retreat and annual short play festival.

[Moompetam American Indian Festival](#)

Aquarium of the Pacific hosts this annual festival celebrating indigenous cultures of Southern California. It features "traditional cultural craft demonstrations, storytelling, music, and dance."

Don't forget to celebrate Indigenous Peoples' Day on the second Monday of October! Find a venue that involves the participation of Native people.

Sources: [autry museum website](#); [Native voices website](#); [La Skins Fest Website](#); [Aquarium of the Pacific Website](#)

Photo Sources: [canva](#)

Slide 5.3 – Support – Don’t Just Acknowledge, Build Relationships – Volunteer (Layer 2)

Here are some organizations that depend on volunteers to support efforts aligned with Native values. Hover over each one to learn more. Clicking on the name of the organization will take you to its website. Download the “Volunteer Organizations Handout” in the resources section of the course player.

[Antelope Valley Indian Museum](#) – This museum displays arts of the Native cultures of the western Great Basin, California, and Southwest. They accept volunteer applications for docents.

[Santa Monica Conservancy](#) – This is a nonprofit organization committed to "promoting widespread understanding and appreciation of the cultural, social, economic and environmental benefits of historic preservation." They accept applications to volunteer year-round.

[Southern California Indian Center, Inc. \(SCIC\)](#): This community-based organization provides workforce development, youth education, and family support for Native people. They are seeking applications for volunteers to assist in a variety of ways.

[Autry Museum](#) – The Autry Museum holds a plethora of diverse Native art and promotes the cultural practices of Native communities. They seek volunteers for everything from data entry to letter-writing to visitor greeting.

[Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians](#) – This Indigenous Nation seeks volunteers for a variety of roles as they arise. They have initiatives surrounding conservation and AcknowledgeRent.



Below is the handout referenced in the narration:



VOLUNTEER ORGANIZATIONS

CLICK ON THE ORGANIZATIONS TO VISIT THEIR WEBSITES

[Antelope Valley Indian Museum](#)

This museum displays arts of the Native cultures of the western Great Basin, California, and Southwest. They accept volunteer applications for docents.

[Santa Monica Conservancy](#)

This is a nonprofit organization committed to "promoting widespread understanding and appreciation of the cultural, social, economic and environmental benefits of historic preservation." They accept applications to volunteer year-round.

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Sources: [Antelope Valley Indian Museum Website](#); [Santa Monica Conservancy Website](#); [SCIC Website](#); [Autry Museum Website](#); [Fernandeño Tataviam Band of Mission Indians Website](#)

Photo Sources: [Tataviam website](#); [Canva](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment

As authentic allies to the American Indian & Alaska Native population, it's important that we act after acknowledgment. There are 4 ways we can do this:

1. Support Native-Made Art and Products
2. Support Indigenous Businesses
3. Avoid Purchasing Native "Themed" Products
4. Pay AcknowledgeRent

Click on each to learn more about each one.



Sources: [LAHSA CDE Presentation](#); [buynative.com](#); [spectrum news website](#); [Acknowledge Rent Website](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Support Native Made Art and Products Intro (Layer 1)
 Watching, reading, and listening to Native American literature, film, and music demonstrates support for Native artists. As Los Angeles is an epicenter for the arts, Angelenos have many opportunities to support. Click on each medium to learn about some Native artists; there are plenty of others out there as well!

Visual Artists

Musical Artists

Filmmakers

Authors



Source: [LAHSA CDE Presentation](#)

Photo Source: [Canva](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Support Native Made Art and Products - Visual Artists (Layer 2)

Hover over each artist to learn about them. Those with an LA County seal next to them are known to reside in our area. If you'd like to learn more about them, clicking on their name will take you to a website outside of this course.*

**[Joel Garcia](#) - "Joel Garcia (Huichol) is an artist, arts administrator and cultural organizer with 20+ years of experience working transnationally focusing on community-centered strategies. His approach is rooted in Indigenous-based forms of dialoguing and decision-making (non hierarchical) that uplifts non-institutional expertise."*

**[Kimberly Dawn Robertson](#) - Kimberly Dawn Robertson's work addresses "the settler colonial and heteropatriarchal violences that plague Indigenous communities." She is the Co-Creative Director of Meztli Projects, which is "an Indigenous and youth centered arts collective."*

**[River Garza](#) - River Garza's "work draws on traditional Indigenous aesthetics, Southern California Indigenous maritime culture, skateboarding, Graffiti, Mexican culture, and Low Rider culture." With other Native artists, he worked on [Tongvaland](#), a public exhibition "dedicated to the empowerment, recognition and social justice for Tongva Indian peoples."*

**[Mercedes Dorame](#) – Mercedes Dorame "calls on her Tongva ancestry to engage the problematics of (in)visibility and ideas of cultural construction." Her work is featured in many prominent museums, including Hammer Museum, San Francisco Museum of Modern Art, and The Triton Museum.*

**[Weshoyot Alvitre](#) - "Weshoyot Alvitre is a Tongva and Scottish comic book artist, writer and illustrator." "Her work focuses on art and writing that visualizes historical material through an Indigenous lens."*

[Marina Perez-Wong](#) - Marina Perez-Wong "took to art as a form of communication, self expression, and escape" after surviving a rare childhood cancer. Her "work is motivated by the healing of current and generational trauma, community, history, local and global politics" and education.

[Brad Kahlhamer](#) - "Brad Kahlhamer is an artist working in a range of media including sculpture, drawing, painting, performance, and music." "His work references hallmarks of twentieth-century abstract painting, such as German Expressionism, while incorporating highly personal iconography."

[Jaune Quick-to-See Smith](#) - Jaune Quick-to-See Smith is a painter and sculpturer. Her work uses "humor and satire to present narratives on ethical treatment of animal, humans and our planet."

[Marie Watt](#) - Marie Watt's "interdisciplinary work draws from history, biography, Iroquois protofeminism, and Indigenous teachings" where "she explores the intersection of history, community, and storytelling." Most of her work is done in partnership with Elaine Chu.

[Nicholas Galanin](#) - "Galanin's works embody critical thought as vessels of knowledge, culture and technology – inherently political, generous, unflinching, and poetic."



(hovering over an artist reveals additional text/imagery)



Sources: [Joel Garcia](#) website; [Kimberly Dawn Robertson](#) website; [River Garza Website](#); [Twin Walls Mural Website](#); [Brad Kahlhamer Website](#); [Jaune Quick-to-See Smith Website](#); [Marie Watt Website](#); [Nicholas Galanin Google Drive](#); [Mercedes Dorame Website](#); [Weshoyot Alvitre Website](#)
Photo Sources: [Canva](#); [zocalopublicsquare.org](#), [wikipedia](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Support Native Made Art and Products - Musical Artists (Layer 3)

Hover over each artist to learn about them. Those with an LA County seal next to them are known to reside in our area. If you'd like to learn more about them, clicking on their name will take you to a website outside of this course.*

*[Raye Zaragoza](#) - Raye Zaragoza is a singer songwriter of Indigenous, Asian, and Latina heritage. Her sounds are typically contemplative and calming. Hear her music on Netflix's Spirit Rangers.

*[Redbone](#) - Redbone is a rock band with a rich history and are in the Native American Music Awards Hall of Fame. You might already be familiar with their single "Come and Get Your Love" that went platinum and has been featured in a variety of media including the movie Guardians of the Galaxy.

*[Kelly Caballero](#) - Kelly Caballero is a singer songwriter who resides in Los Angeles. Her soothing voice is typically accompanied by ukulele.

*[Jessa Calderon](#) - Jessa Calderon is a "Singer, Song Writer, Emcee (rapper), Poet, and Published Author" of the Chumash and Tongva Nations. She uses her music to "share her culture and truth."

[Supaman](#) - Supaman is an "innovative hip hop artist who has dedicated his life to empowering and spreading a message of hope, pride, and resilience." His music is an inventive blend of traditional Apsaalooke music and modern hip hop.

[Laura Niquay](#) - Laura Niquay sings folk music in her native language of Atikamekw. She was winner of Indigenous artist of the year at the ADISQ gala.

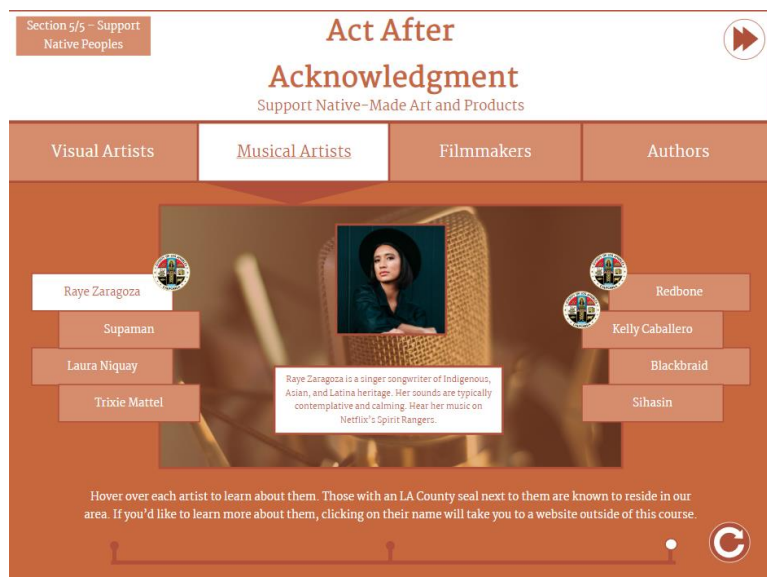
[Blackbraid](#) - BlackBraid is the solo Black Metal project of Sgah'gahsowáh. His music "is inspired by the forces of nature in the land around us."

[Trixie Mattel](#) - Trixie Mattel is a drag queen with four acclaimed albums. They were the winner of "RuPaul's Drag Race All Stars" season 3 and are featured on Netflix's "I Like To Watch."

[Sihasin](#) - Sihasin are a brother and sister duo that have been creating music together for 30 years. Their sound is a blend of traditional Navajo music, rock, folk, and pop.



(hovering over an artist reveals additional text/imagery)



Sources: Raye Zaragoza [Website](#) and [Spotify page](#); Redbone [Spotify Page](#); Kelly Caballero [Medium Article](#); Supaman [website](#); Laura Niquay [website](#); Blackbraid [website](#); Trixie Mattel [Spotify page](#); Sihasin [Spotify page](#); Jessa Calderon [Website](#)
Photo Sources: [Canva](#), [imdb](#), [wikipedia](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Support Native Made Art and Products - Filmmakers (Layer 4)

Hover over each artist to learn about them. If you'd like to learn more about them, clicking on their name will take you to a website outside of this course.

[Georgina Lightning](#) - Georgina Lightning is an award-winning actress, producer, and director. She is a co-founder of Tribal Alliance Productions, who specializes in media from a Native perspective.

[Chris Eyre](#) - Chris Eyre has directed and produced a variety of films and TV series. Some of his work includes Smoke Signals and Skins.

[Tracey Deer](#) - Tracey Deer is a showrunner, writer, and director. Her feature film Beans is available for streaming on Hulu.

[Billy Luther](#) - Billy Luther is a writer, director, and producer. His film Frybread Face and Me follows two adolescent Navajo cousins learning about their Native ancestry.

[Shirley Cheechoo](#) - Shirley Cheechoo is an actress, writer, and director. Her film Backroads won the American Indian Movie Award for Best Film.

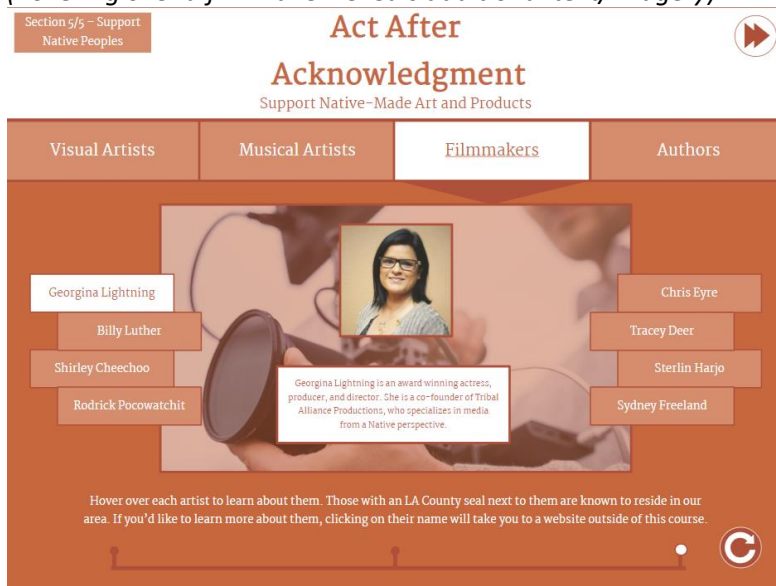
[Sterlin Harjo](#) - Sterlin Harjo is a co-creator of FX's Reservation Dogs, a comedy series following four Native teenagers in Oklahoma. He also directed Love and Fury, a documentary film centering on Native artists.

[Sydney Freeland](#) - Sydney Freeland is a director and writer. Her credits include episodes of Nancy Drew and Reservation Dogs.

[Rodrick Pocowatchit](#) - Rodrick Pocowatchit is a director and writer known for works such as Apocalypse... Then and The Incredible Brown NDN. His directorial debut Red Hand follows a time traveler intent on saving Native people.



(hovering over a filmmaker reveals additional text/imagery)



Sources: [Georgina Lightning](#) IMDB page; [Chris Eyre](#) IMDB page; [Tracey Deer](#) website; [Billy Luther](#) IMDB page; [Shirley Cheechoo](#) IMDB page; [Sterlin Harjo](#) IMDB page; [Sydney Freeland](#) IMDB page; [Rodrick Pocowatchit](#) IMDB page

Photo Sources: [Canva](#); [imdb](#); [wikipedia](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Support Native Made Art and Products - Authors (Layer 5)

Hover over each author to learn about them. Those with an LA County seal next to them* are known to reside in our area. If you'd like to learn more about them, clicking on their name will take you to a website outside of this course.

**[Tommy Pico](#) - Tommy Pico is the author of four poetry collections and has received a variety of awards. He is also a co-host of the podcast Food 4 Thot.*

**[David Treuer](#) - David Treuer is a Professor of English at the University of Southern California (USC). He has written six books and his essays have appeared in the Washington Post and LA Times.*

[Louise Erdrich](#) - Louise Erdrich has written several novels and is the owner of Birchbark Books. She is a winner of a Pulitzer Prize and the National Book Award for Fiction.

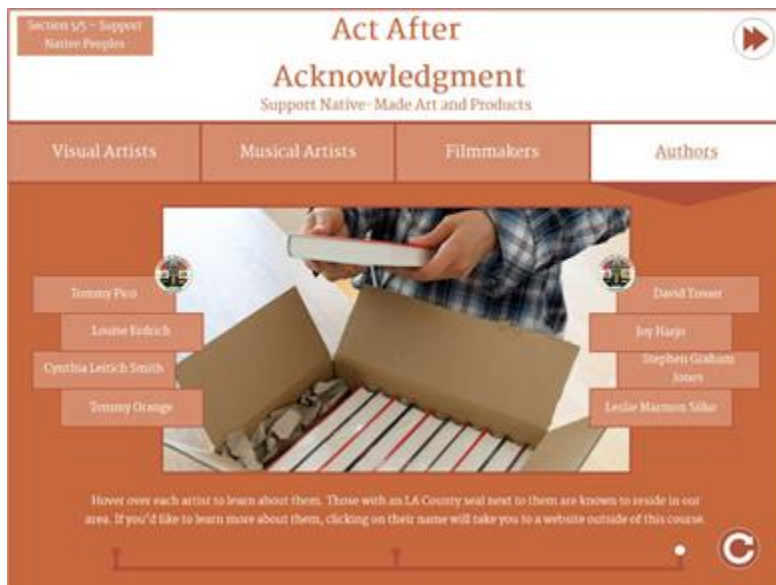
[Joy Harjo](#) - Joy Harjo has written ten poetry books and two memoirs. She is the winner of Yale's 2023 Bollingen Prize for American Poetry. She is also a musician and performer.

[Stephen Graham Jones](#) - Stephen Graham Jones is a New York Times best-selling author with a prolific catalog. He is known for working in the horror genre.

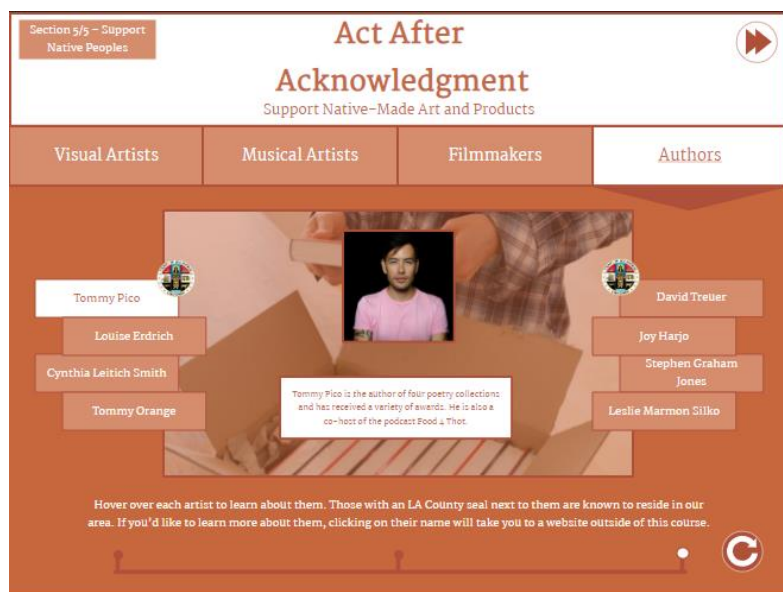
[Cynthia Leitich Smith](#) – Cynthia Leitich Smith has written 18 books, most of which are for kids and teens. Many of her novels' protagonists are contemporary Native adolescents.

[Tommy Orange](#) - Tommy Orange has written two books and was a finalist for the 2019 Pulitzer Prize. He resides in Oakland California.

[Leslie Marmon Silko](#) – Leslie Marmon Silko is one of the most acclaimed Native authors working today. She is known for abstract work that requires reader interpretation. She cites her family's storytelling as an influence on her method.



(hovering over an author reveals additional text/imagery)



Sources: [Poets.org](https://www.poets.org/); [David Treuer website](#); [Birchbark Books website](#); [Stephen Graham Jones website](#); [Cynthia Leitich Smith website](#); [Penguin Random House Website](#); [Poetry Foundation Website](#)
Photo Sources: [Canva](#), [New York Review of Books](#), [wikipedia](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Support Indigenous Businesses (Layer 6)

Support Indigenous businesses to contribute to Native economic empowerment. Below are some for you to explore, and there are also plenty of others. The one with an LA County seal next to them* originates from our area. Hover over the business to learn more about it. Clicking on a business name will take you to their website. Download the “Native Businesses Handout” in the resources section of the course player.

*[Urban Native Era](#) – Urban Native Era was created to “increase the visibility of Indigenous Peoples.” Using “minimal yet powerful designs to create timeless garments,” their clothes are “made for everyone.”

[B. Yellowtail](#) – B. Yellowtail “are a Native American woman owned fashion & lifestyle brand dedicated to sharing authentic Indigenous design with the world.”

[Kotah Bear](#) - Kotah Bear is jewelry retailer owned and operated by a brother and sister of the Navajo tribe. They specialize in handcrafted items by Native artisans.

[Sage & Oats](#) – Sage & Oats is a Native-owned online and physical retailer that specializes “in handcrafted gifts which celebrate Montana’s rich history, culture & diversity.”

[Medicine of the People](#) – For 22 years, Medicine of the People have been making products that have their “people’s needs in mind.” They carry products that range in use from beauty to insect bite treatment.

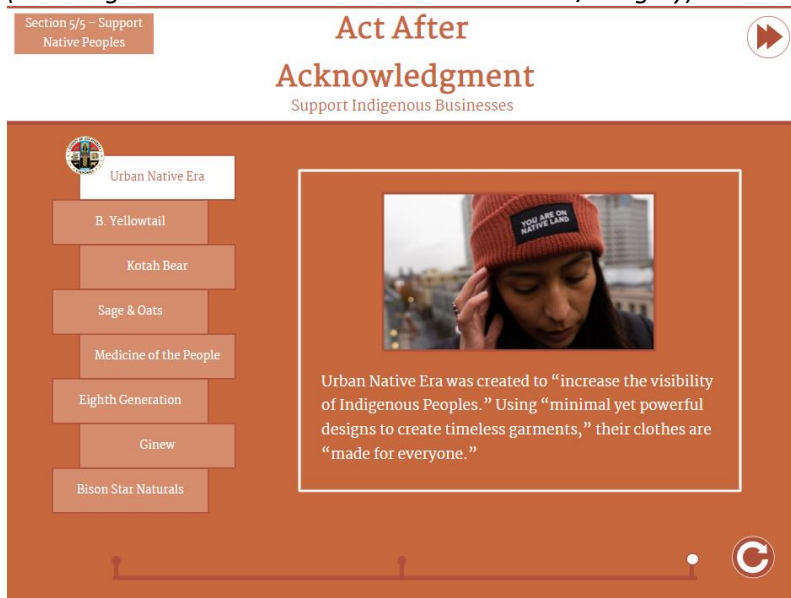
[Eighth Generation](#) - “Eighth Generation provides a strong, ethical alternative to “Native-inspired” art and products through its artist-centric approach and 100% Native designed products.” They are the first Native-owned business in the United States “to sell Native-designed wool blankets.”

[Ginew](#) – Ginew clothes are “meant to last – meant to be handed down to the next generation.” Their intention is to uplift Native Americans and create garments that all can enjoy.

[Bison Star Naturals](#) - Bison Star Naturals is a Native family-owned business that creates and sells natural soaps. None of their products contain “animal products, dyes or perfumes.”



(hovering over a business reveals additional text/imagery)



Sources: [Goodhousekeeping.com](#); [Urban Native Website](#); [B Yellowtail website](#); [Kotahbear website](#); [Shenative website](#); [Sage & Oats website](#); [Medicine of the people website](#); [Eighth Generation Website](#); [Ginew Website](#); [Bison Star Naturals Website](#)

Photo Sources: Articulate, [karmalize.org](#)

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Avoid Purchasing Native “Themed” Products (Layer 7)

Being an ethical consumer means avoiding purchasing Native “themed” products. When someone purchases Native “themed” products, they are contributing to the theft of intellectual property and degrading cultural respect. The money being spent on such products should be going to a Native-owned business.

It is not only unethical to purchase Native “themed” products, but also against the law. The Indian Arts and Crafts Act of 1990 is “a truth-in-advertising law that prohibits misrepresentation in the marketing of Indian art and craft products within the United States.” The U.S. Department of the Interior explains that “it is illegal to offer or display for sale, or sell, any art or craft product in a manner that falsely suggests it is Indian produced.”

Make sure that your purchase of anything Native related is supporting Native people.



Source: [US Department of the Interior Website](#);

Photo Source: Articulate

Slide 5.4 – Support – Act After Acknowledgment – Pay AcknowledgeRent (Layer 8)

Settler colonialism establishes that all non-Native people are settlers in the United States of America. As a means of reversing the effects of land dispossession, we can participate in AcknowledgeRent. AcknowledgeRent is the practice of compensating tribal nations in return for our use of their land. It is the most direct way to support the equitable treatment of Indian American and Alaska Native people.

To participate in AcknowledgeRent, begin by researching the Indigenous nation that originates where you reside. Then, donate directly to them.

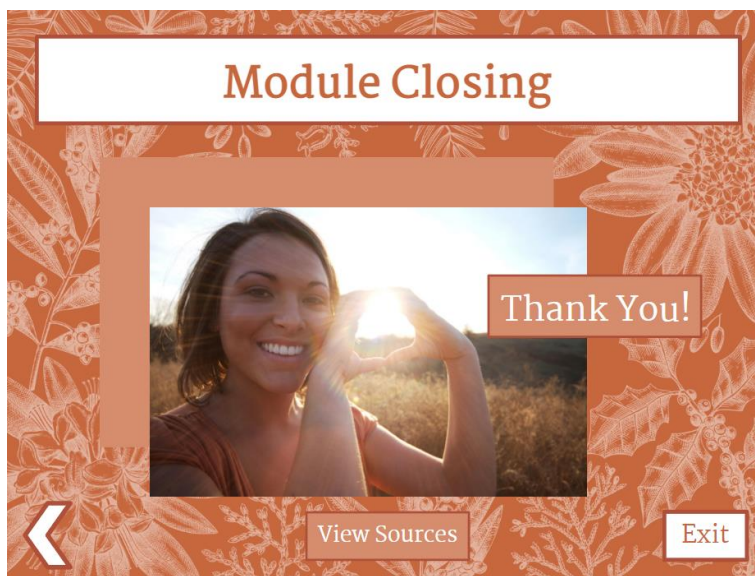


Source: [AcknowledgeRent Website](#)

Photo Source: Articulate

Slide 5.5 – Module Closing

You're about to complete the first module of LAHSA's American Indian & Alaska Native Equity Building E-Learning Course. Well done! Thank you for your commitment to cultural humility. Your learning has set the groundwork for improving homeless services for American Indian & Alaska Native people. This module has used a variety of sources to build our curriculum. Feel free to explore them by clicking the "View Sources" button. The second module will cover Identity, Terminology, and Symptoms of Structural Racism. Click "Exit" to complete this module. See you in Module 2!



Source pages below:

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Data Summary

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Homeless Count LAHSA
Data Summary

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Website

Autry Museum
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Website

Buy Native
Website

AcknowledgeRent
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Rage One
Website

Kimberly Dawn
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Website



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Website

Brad Kahlhamer
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Nicholas Galanin
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Mercedes Dorame
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Weshoyot Alvitre
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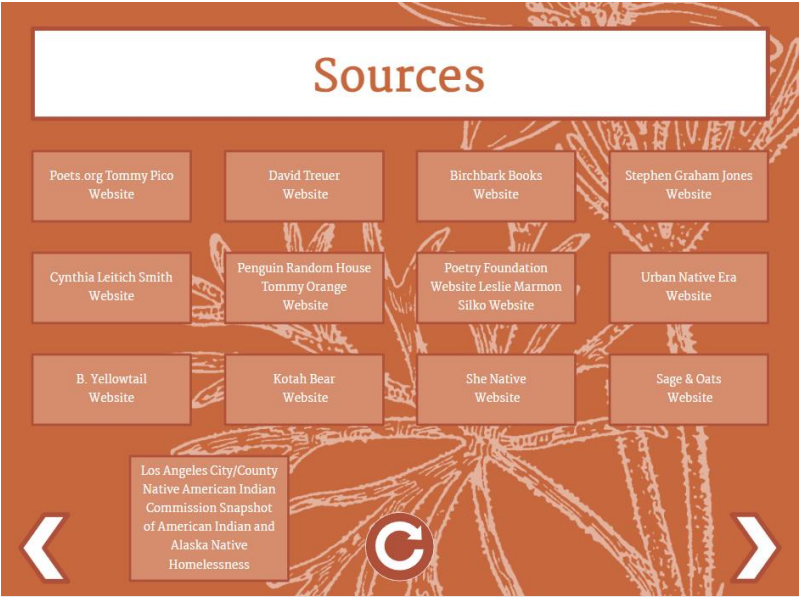
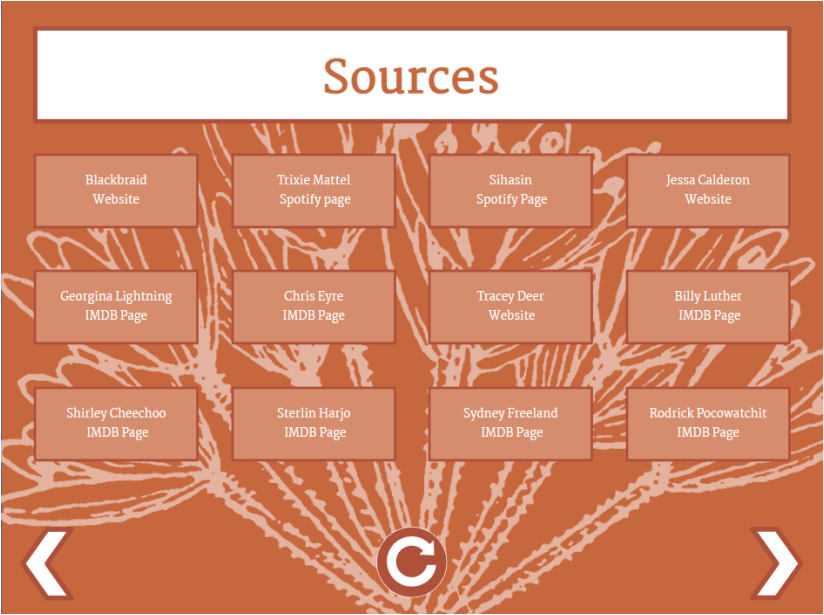
Raye Zaragoza
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Redbone
Spotify Page

Supaman
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Laura Niquay
Website





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Homelessness
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Photo Source: [Canva](#)